From: **Rob Reuss** robreuss@mac.com
Subject: Ambiguous line breaks
Date: June 21, 2025 at 2:09 PM
To: Marc Weiss mweiss@weblab.org

You'll see in one of the attached a poem, a post with some unwanted line breaks due to how the post was submitted, and a paragraph-based that looks correct.

I can fix this but I need a rule (the AI can handle generating the function to do it).

I propose this, which should handle these three cases in a reasonably good way:

Two line breaks (which is what you see in the well-formatted paragraph example) are allowed, but only when the preceding line is terminated with a period.

1. Shouldn't change correctly formatted formatted paragraphs.

2. Poems will be tightened up so that, assuming they intended period terminated stanzas. It might not be exactly right if the author ended a stanza with a comma, but it won't disrupt the meaning much.

3. In the case of normal paragraph text that is incorrectly broken in the middle of lines (hard line breaks) that mid-sentence breaks will be removed by stripping the line feed characters.

If you think this is roughly correct I can implement it and we can review the impact. It'll be good to tighten things up - these are super-long pages.

Paul

THE GIFT THAT KEEP ON GIVING

By Arthur Varanelli on Oct 31, 1997 at 5:53 AM

PTSD is one of those things that you really don't know what it is or how to handle it even after someone tells you that you have it, because you see yourself as quite normal while you swing between pairs of opposites, go pasive-agressive, or go hide with recurrent depression.

It has taken me several years just to understand this and admit to myself that I am stuck with it. It is not true denial. Reality shifts all over the place, and however I may be from moment to moment, it is all very real to me, even if it is contradictory to someone else. Justification and common sense is also very distorted.

This is the part that my wife of 26 years has the most difficulty. I know now underneath it all is the real me, and the real me now knows how to make an appearance more often than not. It will continue to be very hard work for as long as I live, but being "me" is worth it!

There is help, and real hope out there for both sides. Just remember that we are all victims and survivors at the same time.

The Vietnam War may be physically over, but it still lives in our minds.

PTSD, the gift that keeps on giving!

--Art

By Anne on Nov 8, 1997 at 9:57 PM

Michael,

My heart goes out to you...I have not experienced PTSD myself, but I'm in a

relationship with a vet who has and work

with people in the throws of this

nightmare. Your description of your

feelings fit that profile to the "T".

There are some wonderful men on these

pages who have experienced the same thing and would welcome you with open arms and

would have more credible advice than I.

But here are my thoughts: I can say that you MUST start by being

kind to yourself - PTSD is an entirely

normal reaction to abnormal experiences,

but "you" are not your symptoms. You are having this reaction because you are a

feeling, compassionate human (even though some of your ways of behaving may make

you think otherwise) - embrace your own

arrogance, innocence and ignorance.

Witness this fire mission through the eyes of an FNG... ME!

"The Show"

Dust and spiders fall from the rafters

each time the big guns roar.

Rickety cots creak and dance

across the rough plank floor.

I squint my eyes and plug my ears,

as I roll in a pool of sweat.

But sleep is shattered by the cannons' report

and slinks from their resounding threat.

Once outside, in the moonless dark

I struggle to gain my senses.

Awake, at last, I take a seat,

near a sea of barbed wire fences.